

There are a lot of people in the world, and I have to **accommodate** my liberty to their liberties. We are all liable to forget this, and unfortunately we are much more conscious of the imperfections of others in this respect than of our own. A reasonable **consideration** for the rights or feelings of others is the foundation of social conduct. It is in the small matters of conduct, in the observance of the rules of the road, that we pass judgment upon ourselves, and declare that we are civilized or uncivilized. The great moments of heroism and sacrifice are rare. It is the little habits of commonplace intercourse that make up the great sum of life and sweeten or make bitter the journey.

About The Author



Alfred George Gardiner was a British journalist and author. He was a prolific essayist and his style and subject matter easily qualified him to be categorized as what the English would call a very civilized gentleman. His essays include 'On Habits', 'On Being Tidy' and 'On Talk and Talkers'. 'On the Rule of the Road', was included in one of Gardiner's compilations titled 'Leaves in the Wind' and was published under his pseudonym "Alpha of the Plough".

Glossary

confusion	-	mess
peril	-	risk
pedestrians	-	persons who walk on the streets
chaos	-	confusion
anarchy	-	lawlessness/ rebellion
preserved	-	maintained
curtailed	-	reduced
tyranny	-	autocracy
insolence	-	rudeness
interfere	-	hinder
contract	-	commitment
indifferent	-	unconcerned
fancy	-	desire
shandy	-	lemonade
ridiculous	-	comical
conventional	-	normal
accommodate	-	fit in with
consideration	-	scrutiny

1. Answer the following questions in one or two sentences each.

a. Why did the lady think she was entitled to walk down the middle of the road?

b. What would be the consequence of the old lady's action?

c. What does the 'rule of the road' mean?

d. Why should individual liberty be curtailed?

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